SEÁN Ó MURCHÚ

Senior Software Engineer

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Lead a platform team building reliable, event-driven systems.

Backend engineer with eight years of experience designing distributed, event-driven systems. Specialises in functional programming, observability, and developer experience.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer
Jun 2022 – Present
Acme Corp
Dublin, Ireland

Platform team lead. Owns the event-sourcing stack underpinning the wider product surface.

- Led the migration of a customer-facing monolith into a set of event-driven microservices, halving p99 latency.
- Designed and rolled out an event-sourcing platform now used by four product teams.
- Mentored three engineers from mid to senior level.

Scala · Go · Kafka · Kubernetes

Software Engineer
Jun 2019 – Jun 2021
Liffey Labs
Remote

- Built and shipped the first version of a SaaS product from scratch alongside a two-person team.
- Introduced the CI/CD pipeline and developer-onboarding flow that scaled the engineering org from 3 to 15.

Python · Go · AWS · GitHub Actions

VOLUNTEER

Mentor
Jun 2020 – Present
CoderDojo Dublin

Volunteer-led coding club introducing young people to programming.

- Weekly mentoring sessions for 10–14 year-olds learning to code.
- Curate the Scala / functional-programming track.

PROJECTS

Application
Hyperion
Jan 2024 – Aug 2024
Acme Corp · Lead, Architect

Distributed task scheduler in Rust

- Handled 10k tasks/s on a single node.
- Designed an idempotent retry protocol.

Rust · Tokio · gRPC

Library
Tinkerbell

Tiny IRC bot

Lua

AREAS OF FOCUS

- Distributed systems: Kafka, CDC, idempotent consumers, event sourcing.
- Functional programming and type-driven design in Scala and Haskell.
- Developer experience: tooling, CI/CD, observability.

SKILLS

Languages – Scala · Haskell · Python · Go · Rust

Infra – Kafka · AWS · Terraform · Docker · Kubernetes

LANGUAGES

English ●●●●●●
French ●●●●○○
Portuguese ●●◐○○○

EDUCATION

M.Sc. in Computer Science
2017 – 2019
Tallaght Institute of Technology
Distinction
Distributed Systems · Type Theory · Concurrency

Computer Science
2014 – 2017
Trinity College Dublin

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator
Aug 2023 – Aug 2026
CNCF · LF-1A2B3C4D5E

Other
Quill

PUBLICATIONS

Articles
- *Event Sourcing in Practice*.
  Personal Blog · 14 Jun 2024
  A walk-through of idempotent Kafka consumers and the replay strategy that ships with them.

Conference Papers
- *Idempotent Kafka Consumers at Scale*.
  A. Lovelace, **S. Ó Murchú**, G. Hopper
  EuroSys · Apr 2024
  DOI 10.1000/182

Talks
- *Designing for Failure*.
  ScalaIO · Sep 2023

INTERESTS

Music: Trad, Jazz
Sport: Hurling, Climbing

AWS Solutions Architect — Professional — May 2023
AWS

Hashicorp Terraform Associate
Hashicorp

AWARDS

Best Paper Award — Sep 2024
ScalaConf
For Idempotent Kafka Consumers.

Dean's List

REFERENCES

Dr Ada Lovelace
Seán is a calm, methodical engineer who left every system he touched in a better state than he found it. Recommended without reservation.

Pragmatic, curious, unfailingly kind — would hire again in a heartbeat.